Diverse perspectives in the curriculum

Whose knowledge and perspectives are represented?

WHAT IS IT?

Diverse identities, disciplines, and ways of knowing are represented through readings and guest speakers, where feasible

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Teaching is never neutral. Choices about readings, cases, examples, guest speakers, classroom norms and professional pathways tell students whose lives and knowledge are considered normal, legitimate or peripheral. When students cannot recognise themselves or their communities in the discipline, participation can start to feel risky or pointless.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “People like me do not seem to exist in this field.”
- “We only appear when the course is discussing disadvantage or a problem.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Review who appears across readings, examples and guest speakers over the full course or program, not just one week.
- Add texts, cases and professional voices that widen what counts as expertise within the discipline.
- Show students that there are multiple credible ways into the field and multiple communities affected by it.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A first-year course audits its readings and replaces a narrow set of authors with a broader mix of disciplinary, community and practitioner voices.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

This course has been designed to represent a meaningful range of identities, communities, disciplines and ways of knowing across the curriculum.

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